



GSFA Online

Updated up to the 48th Session of the Codex Alimentarius Commission (2025)

FOOD ADDITIVE GROUP DETAILS

ASCORBYL ESTERS

The provisions that follow are defined at the additive group level, and thus apply to the *total* content of the additives participating in this group. Additives that make up this group are provided for reference only.

Participating Additive(s)

INS No.	Additive Name
304	Ascorbyl palmitate
305	Ascorbyl stearate

CSV (Tables)

GSFA Provisions for ASCORBYL ESTERS

Number	Food Category	Max Level	Notes
07.0	Bakery wares	1,000 mg/kg	Note 15 Note 10
01.3.2	Beverage whiteners	80 mg/kg	Note XS250 Note XS252 Note 10
06.3	Breakfast cereals, including rolled oats	200 mg/kg	Note 10
02.1.1	Butter oil, anhydrous milkfat, ghee	500 mg/kg	Note 171 Note 10
06.5	Cereal and starch based desserts (e.g. rice pudding, tapioca pudding)	500 mg/kg	Note 2 Note 10
12.6.4	Clear sauces (e.g. fish sauce)	200 mg/kg	Note XS302 Note 10
13.2	Complementary foods for infants and young children	200 mg/kg	Note 187 Note 15
05.0	Confectionery	500 mg/kg	Note XS105 Note XS86 Note XS309R Note XS141 Note 375 Note 15 Note 10
01.7	Dairy-based desserts (e.g. pudding, fruit or flavoured yoghurt)	500 mg/kg	Note 10 Note 2 Note XS243
13.5	Dietetic foods (e.g. supplementary foods for dietary use) excluding products of food categories 13.1 - 13.4 and 13.6	500 mg/kg	Note 10
13.3	Dietetic foods intended for special medical purposes (excluding products of food category 13.1)	10 mg/kg	Note 560 Note 187
13.4	Dietetic formulae for slimming purposes and weight reduction	500 mg/kg	Note 10
04.1.2.2	Dried fruit	80 mg/kg	Note 10
04.2.2.2	Dried vegetables (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), seaweeds, and nuts and seeds	80 mg/kg	Note 613 Note 10
08.4	Edible casings (e.g. sausage casings)	5,000 mg/kg	Note 10

Number	Food Category	Max Level	Notes
 03.0	Edible ices, including sherbet and sorbet	200 mg/kg	 Note 15  Note 10
 10.4	Egg-based desserts (e.g. custard)	500 mg/kg	 Note 2  Note 10
 12.6.1	Emulsified sauces and dips (e.g. mayonnaise, salad dressing, onion dip)	500 mg/kg	 Note 15  Note 10
 02.3	Fat emulsions mainly of type oil-in-water, including mixed and/or flavoured products based on fat emulsions	500 mg/kg	 Note 10
 02.2.2	Fat spreads, dairy fat spreads and blended spreads	500 mg/kg	 Note 10
 02.4	Fat-based desserts excluding dairy-based dessert products of food category 01.7	80 mg/kg	 Note 10
 13.1.2	Follow-up formulae	50 mg/kg	 Note 315  Note 381  Note 551  Note 187
 13.6	Food supplements	500 mg/kg	 Note 10
 13.1.3	Formulae for special medical purposes for infants	10 mg/kg	 Note 381  Note 551  Note 187
 09.2.2	Frozen battered fish, fish fillets, and fish products, including mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms	1,000 mg/kg	 Note 10
 09.2.1	Frozen fish, fish fillets, and fish products, including mollusks, crustaceans, and echinoderms	1,000 mg/kg	 Note XS315  Note XS312  Note XS95  Note XS191  Note 392  Note 10  Note XS92  Note XS36  Note XS190
 04.1.2.9	Fruit-based desserts, including fruit-flavoured water-based desserts	500 mg/kg	 Note 2  Note 10
 12.2	Herbs, spices, seasonings and condiments (e.g. seasoning for instant noodles)	500 mg/kg	 Note XS344  Note XS347  Note XS345  Note XS342  Note XS328  Note XS327  Note XS353  Note XS352  Note XS343  Note XS351  Note 10  Note XS326
 13.1.1	Infant formulae	10 mg/kg	 Note 381  Note 551  Note 187
 02.1.3	Lard, tallow, fish oil, and other animal fats	500 mg/kg	 Note 526  Note 10
 01.5.2	Milk and cream powder analogues	80 mg/kg	 Note 10
 01.5.1	Milk powder and cream powder (plain)	500 mg/kg	 Note XS290  Note 10  Note 545
 12.6.3	Mixes for sauces and gravies	200 mg/kg	 Note 10
 12.4	Mustards	500 mg/kg	 Note 10
 12.6.2	Non-emulsified sauces (e.g. ketchup, cheese sauce, cream sauce, brown gravy)	500 mg/kg	 Note XS306  Note 10
 11.4	Other sugars and syrups (e.g. xylose, maple syrup, sugar toppings)	200 mg/kg	 Note 10
 06.4.3	Pre-cooked pastas and noodles and like products	500 mg/kg	 Note 211  Note 10

Number	Food Category	Max Level	Notes
 15.2	Processed nuts, including coated nuts and nut mixtures (with e.g. dried fruit)	200 mg/kg	 Note 10
 01.6.2.1	Ripened cheese, includes rind	500 mg/kg	 Note 112  Note XS264  Note XS277  Note XS272  Note XS267  Note XS274  Note XS208  Note XS269  Note XS271  Note XS270  Note XS263  Note XS283  Note XS265  Note XS266  Note XS278  Note XS276  Note XS268  Note 10
 12.7	Salads (e.g. macaroni salad, potato salad) and sandwich spreads excluding cocoa- and nut-based spreads of food categories 04.2.2.5 and 05.1.3	200 mg/kg	 Note 10
 15.1	Snacks - potato, cereal, flour or starch based (from roots and tubers, pulses and legumes)	200 mg/kg	 Note 10
 12.5	Soups and broths	200 mg/kg	 Note 10
 06.8.1	Soybean-based beverages	500 mg/kg	 Note 643  Note 187
 01.6.1	Unripened cheese	500 mg/kg	 Note XS273  Note 10  Note XS221
 02.1.2	Vegetable oils and fats	500 mg/kg	 Note XS33  Note 10  Note XS325R  Note 511
 14.1.4	Water-based flavoured drinks, including "sport," "energy," or "electrolyte" drinks and particulated drinks	1,000 mg/kg	 Note 15  Note 10

Note: Unless otherwise specified, food additive provisions apply to the food category indicated (e.g. Dairy), as well as to all subcategories of that category (e.g. Cheese, Ripened Cheese, etc.).

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